Horizon Delta University Student Handbook 2026-2027

Document ID: HDU-SH-2026-01 | Version 1.0 | Academic year: 2026-2027 | Language: English | Currency: Egyptian pound (EGP) | Purpose: RAG chatbot testing

FICTIONAL UNIVERSITY DISCLAIMER. Horizon Delta University (HDU) is a fictional institution. All rules, dates, fees, names and contact details in this document are invented for software demonstration and testing only. No real university or student is described.

1. About the University

1.1 Overview

Horizon Delta University (HDU) is a fictional private university in New Cairo, Egypt, imagined as founded in 2012. It has three faculties: the Faculty of Computing and AI (code CAI), the Faculty of Business (code BUS) and the Faculty of Engineering (code ENG). The language of instruction is English. The academic year has two regular semesters, Fall and Spring, and an optional Summer semester.

1.2 Registrar's Office contact details (fictional)

Item	Details
Email	registrar@hdu.example
Phone	+20 2 5555 0200
Office hours (Cairo time)	Sunday to Thursday, 09:00 to 15:00. Closed on Fridays, Saturdays and Egyptian public holidays.
Working day	In this handbook a working day means Sunday to Thursday, excluding public holidays.

1.3 Terminology

Term	Meaning
Credit hour	The unit of course workload. Tuition is charged per credit hour.
GPA	Semester grade point average, calculated from the courses of one semester.
CGPA	Cumulative grade point average, calculated from all courses taken at HDU.
Add/drop period	The first two weeks of Fall and Spring (the first week of Summer), when courses can be added or dropped.
W	Withdrawal grade. Shown on the transcript but not used in GPA.
DN	Denied entry to the final exam because of excessive absence. Counts as F.
Academic probation	A warning status for students whose CGPA is below 2.0.
Academic advisor	A faculty member assigned to guide each student on course selection and standing.

2. Academic Calendar 2026-2027

Semester	Classes start	Add/drop deadline	Withdrawal (W) deadline	Final exams	Semester ends
Fall 2026	Sunday 20 September 2026	Thursday 1 October 2026	Thursday 26 November 2026	Sunday 3 January to Thursday 14 January 2027	Thursday 14 January 2027
Spring 2027	Sunday 14 February 2027	Thursday 25 February 2027	Thursday 22 April 2027	Sunday 30 May to Thursday 10 June 2027	Thursday 10 June 2027

Semester	Classes start	Add/drop deadline	Withdrawal (W) deadline	Final exams	Semester ends
Summer 2027 (optional)	Sunday 4 July 2027	Thursday 8 July 2027	Thursday 29 July 2027	Sunday 8 August to Thursday 12 August 2027	Thursday 12 August 2027

Fall 2026: classes start on Sunday 20 September 2026. The add/drop deadline is Thursday 1 October 2026. The withdrawal (W) deadline is Thursday 26 November 2026. Final exams run from Sunday 3 January 2027 to Thursday 14 January 2027, and the semester ends on Thursday 14 January 2027.

Spring 2027: classes start on Sunday 14 February 2027. The add/drop deadline is Thursday 25 February 2027. The withdrawal (W) deadline is Thursday 22 April 2027. Final exams run from Sunday 30 May 2027 to Thursday 10 June 2027, and the semester ends on Thursday 10 June 2027.

Summer 2027 (optional): classes start on Sunday 4 July 2027. The add/drop deadline is Thursday 8 July 2027. The withdrawal (W) deadline is Thursday 29 July 2027. Final exams run from Sunday 8 August 2027 to Thursday 12 August 2027, and the semester ends on Thursday 12 August 2027.

The add/drop period is the first two weeks of Fall and Spring, and the first week of Summer. Students may withdraw from a course until the end of week 10 of Fall and Spring, or the end of week 4 of Summer. Tuition payment deadlines are published in the Tuition and Scholarships document, not in this handbook.

3. Registration and Credit Load

3.1 Credit hour limits

Situation	Credit hour limit
Normal load in Fall or Spring	12 to 18 credit hours. A student registered for at least 12 credit hours is full-time.
Overload	Up to 21 credit hours, only with written approval from the academic advisor and a CGPA of at least 3.3.
Student on academic probation	Maximum 12 credit hours per semester.
Summer semester	Maximum 7 credit hours.

3.2 Prerequisites

Prerequisites are enforced by the registration system. A prerequisite counts as satisfied only if the student earned a grade of C or higher in it. A grade of D does not satisfy a prerequisite. A student may ask for a prerequisite override; it needs the written approval of the head of the department that offers the course.

3.3 Adding, dropping and withdrawing

During the add/drop period a student can add or drop courses in the student portal. A course dropped in this period does not appear on the transcript. After the add/drop deadline and until the withdrawal deadline, a student may withdraw from a course and receives the grade W. A W appears on the transcript, does not affect the GPA, and the credit hours of that course do not count as earned. After the withdrawal deadline a student cannot withdraw and receives the grade actually earned, normally F, unless the Dean approves an exception for a documented emergency.

4. Grading and GPA

4.1 Grading scale

Grade	Percentage	Grade points	Grade	Percentage	Grade points
A	93 to 100	4.0	C	73 to 76	2.0
A-	90 to 92	3.7	C-	70 to 72	1.7
B+	87 to 89	3.3	D+	67 to 69	1.3
B	83 to 86	3.0	D	60 to 66	1.0

Grade	Percentage	Grade points	Grade	Percentage	Grade points
B-	80 to 82	2.7	F	Below 60	0.0
C+	77 to 79	2.3			

4.2 How GPA is calculated

GPA is the sum of (grade points multiplied by credit hours) for every course of the semester, divided by the total credit hours of those courses. CGPA is calculated in the same way using all courses taken at HDU, with repeated courses counted once using the highest grade.

4.3 Passing grades

The minimum passing grade in any course is D (60 percent). However, every major core course must be passed with a grade of C (2.0) or higher to count toward graduation; otherwise the student must repeat it.

4.4 Repeating courses

A course may be repeated up to 2 times, so a student has at most 3 attempts. All attempts appear on the transcript, but only the highest grade counts in the CGPA.

4.5 Incomplete grade

An Incomplete (I) may be granted for a documented reason. The missing work must be finished within 4 weeks after the semester ends, otherwise the I becomes an F.

5. Academic Standing

5.1 Good standing

A student is in good standing when the CGPA is 2.0 or above.

5.2 Academic probation

A student whose CGPA is below 2.0 at the end of a Fall or Spring semester is placed on academic probation. While on probation: (a) the student may register for a maximum of 12 credit hours per semester; (b) the student must meet the academic advisor at least once per semester; (c) merit-based scholarships are suspended, as explained in the Tuition and Scholarships document. The student returns to good standing when the CGPA reaches 2.0, and a suspended scholarship can be reinstated from the following semester.

5.3 Academic dismissal

A student is dismissed if the CGPA is below 2.0 at the end of two consecutive regular semesters (Fall and Spring; Summer is not counted). A dismissed student may appeal in writing to the Academic Standing Committee within 10 calendar days of the notification. The committee decides within 10 working days.

5.4 Dean's List

A student is placed on the Dean's List for a semester if the semester GPA is 3.5 or above, the student completed at least 12 credit hours in that semester, and received no grade below C. The list is announced within 2 weeks after final grades are published.

6. Attendance, Exams and Appeals

6.1 Attendance

A student who is absent from more than 25 percent of the sessions of a course receives the grade DN and cannot sit the final exam. DN counts as F in the GPA.

6.2 Exam rules

A valid HDU student ID card is required in every exam. A student arriving more than 30 minutes after the exam starts is not admitted.

6.3 Make-up exams

A student who missed an exam for a documented reason must submit a request within 3 working days of the missed exam. The head of the department approves or rejects the request. A make-up exam fee applies; the amount is listed in the Student FAQ.

6.4 Grade appeals

A student may appeal a final grade in writing to the head of the department within 7 calendar days after grades are published. The decision is given within 10 working days. A final appeal can be made to the Dean within 5 working days after that decision.

7. Academic Integrity

Offense	Consequence
First offense (for example copying an assignment)	Zero for the work and a written warning in the student file.
Second offense	Grade F in the course.
Third offense, or cheating in an exam by impersonation	Referral to the Disciplinary Committee, which may dismiss the student.

AI tools may be used in a course only if the course syllabus explicitly allows it.

8. Graduation

8.1 Credit hours required by program

Faculty	Degree	Credit hours required
Computing and AI (CAI)	BSc in Computing and AI	132
Business (BUS)	Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA)	126
Engineering (ENG)	Bachelor of Engineering (BEng)	160

8.2 Graduation requirements

To graduate a student must: complete all required credit hours of the program; have a CGPA of at least 2.0; earn C or higher in every major core course; have no unpaid fees; and submit the graduation clearance form in the final semester. The maximum study duration is 1.5 times the normal length of the program.

8.3 Graduation honors

Graduates with a CGPA from 3.5 to 3.79 receive Honors, and graduates with a CGPA of 3.8 or above receive High Honors, provided they have no disciplinary record.